Grayson Iller

Flight Test Engineer Lead, Device Platform

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linkedin.com/in/grayson-iller-a119b2202 | Portfolio | vueniverse.com

SUMMARY

Three years at Skydio validating the controller experience for public safety and national security operators. I map critical user journeys and find the places where the interface and the aircraft disagree. Designed and built VUE solo, from Figma to production. Applying to move from validating these interfaces to designing them.

EXPERIENCE

Skydio | Flight Test Engineer Lead, Device Platform | San Mateo, CA | September 2025 to Present

- Found and documented cases where the controller UI showed a drone as on or connected when it was off, unpaired, or out of reach, then worked with design and engineering to close them.
- Filed 129 UI and UX issues against the controller and mobile app; 83 closed.
- Authored the controller test suite in TestRail, organized by operator flow rather than subsystem. When the suite was restructured by feature, measured the effect: full regression went from about 3.5 weeks to over 4.
- Bridged UX and system-level testing by evaluating real operator workflows and usability under pressure, with a focus on clarity, predictability, and real-world use in public safety and defense.
- On-site at a Bay Area police department for controller radio-interference validation with Wireless and EE; ran the RF interference test matrix that fed the hardware rework. FAA Part 107 certified.
- Manage a direct report who owns mobile device platform validation. Led release validation for a second Controller 2 program for national security customers through GA, alongside the commercial release.

Skydio | Flight Test Engineer | June 2023 to September 2025

- Controller and mobile validation across the S2, X2, and X10 Enterprise platforms; test lead for Controller 2 from bring-up through Beta.

Skydio | Flight Test Intern, UI/Human Factors | May 2022 to August 2022

- Mobile-side flight test: UI/UX feature testing and drone system validation with hardware and software teams, using TestRail, Jira, Instabug, and Figma.

PROJECTS

VUE (vueniverse.com) | Founder, Designer, Engineer | 2024 to Present

- Fashion intelligence platform that aggregates daily new arrivals from 100+ women's fashion brands into one personalized feed. Live in production with real users and affiliate monetization.
- Designed end to end in Figma and FigJam first, then developed with AI-assisted coding workflows using Claude.
- Removed the sign-up wall after retention data showed visitors who opened a product returned at 50% versus 6% for those who did not; moved auth to the point of intent (first follow or save).

SKILLS

Design: Critical user journeys, information architecture, Figma and FigJam, design systems, interaction design

Skydio systems: connectivity switching (direct radio and LTE), activation and login, media, support logs, controller-only releases, Controller 2 bring-up, on-prem deployments

Research: Field validation with public safety operators, usability testing, bug scrub and program review, FAA Part 107

Build: React 18, TypeScript, Tailwind, Supabase, Vercel, AI-assisted development with Claude

Tools: Jira, TestRail, Instabug, Git/GitHub

EDUCATION

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University | B.S. Human Factors Psychology (HCI focus), Minor in Aerospace Physiology | 2019 to 2023

NCAA Division II Women's Cross Country and Track & Field. FAA-certified UAV pilot. PADI Open Water Diver. Olympic-distance triathlon finisher.

PUBLICATIONS

- Tooker, M., Iller, G., French, J., McGrath, B., & Rupert, A. (2022). Pilot-in-the-loop technology for moon landings. IAF/IAA Space Life Sciences Symposium.
- Crichton, C., Delgado, L., Iller, G., et al. (2021). The Link Between Spatial Disorientation in Flight and Mild Hypoxia. Reno Aerospace Medicine Convention.